

Time to exercise...

In a world where companies are out there to earn profits by every passing moment, don't be the convenient bait. It's time to exercise... your rights as a consumer. You don't have to flex your muscles when you have laws to work for you

Case File #14

After reading our LCD monitor test in 2007, Sudip Kumar Saha decided to buy a ViewSonic monitor. It was encouraging to learn how he based his buying decision after reading our verdict. After decent performance for close to two years, the monitor developed some problems with spots appearing on the display. When Saha first wrote to ViewSonic, they told him, "After studying your case deeply and verifying all the technical specifications of the products, we have come to this conclusion that the black patches/spot that appeared on the screen is a result of misuse, external pressure e.g. touching small dot(s) on LCD screens or physical damage and is not covered under warranty. All such problems basically come up due to mishandling. Such cases do not fall within the scope of ViewSonic."

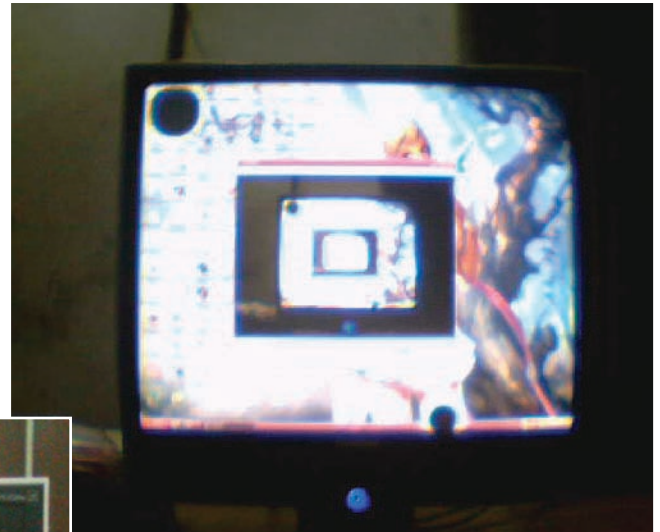


ViewSonic replaced the faulty monitor with a brand new unit two months before the warranty expires

What transpired

On March 22nd, Saha sent an email to servicewatch@thinkdigit.com and a copy of the mail to the editor. Two days later, On the 24th, Ahmed Shaikh, Editor-at-large and online architect, called Saha asking him for all the details of the case.

On the 26th, Saha received an email from ViewSonic along with a RMA/Complaint No. The next day, RT outsourcing's West Bengal branch called Saha and told him that the panel for his model is not available, and will take 3-4 days to repair the monitor. Saha asked for a replacement and was told they



The black spots visible on Saha's ViewSonic monitor

would inform the Bangalore head office about it. On 29th, Saha got another call from the Bangalore head office - they told him they will replace the monitor with another model expected by 2nd April. On 1st April, he got another call and was told that the replacement unit will reach him by April 06. On the 6th, Saha called up their West Bengal branch and enquired about it and they told him it was shipped from Pune. At 6.30 pm on April 06, 2010, the defective unit was replaced with a new one.

Case File #25

Last month was all about a Nokia customer who wrote to us about his Nokia N72 that abruptly started malfunctioning. Within a year of purchasing the phone, Srirengam's phone just died. He approached Nokia's service personnel at the respective service centre in his locality. Unfortunately, he was told nothing could be done about his phone.

A response such as that could be so disheartening. You buy a product with immense hope, and probably most of the time after a lot of asking, consulting, saving and waiting. And one fine day, all you hear is nothing can be done about it, it's gone forever. Amidst the despair and rage, there needs to be a sense of restraint. Patience will take you places, not reckless pursuit. In order to see your product working fine, you could take on one stupid move that would absolve the company of any responsibility.

He wrote to us and we promptly started our follow up. We shared his email with Nokia, and waited for responses. A month later they did get back to us saying the customer had tampered with

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